PREDICTING CHANGE

The Schrödinger equation determines the evolution of a wave function (se pp.36–37), predicting the future behavior of the system of superposed states it describes. It can be considered the quantum equivalent of Newton's laws of motion, which predict changes to a classical system over time. The future behavior of a system cannot be determined with certainty, but the equation allows us to calculate the probability of finding a system in a certain state at some later time.

> **"Where did we get that [Schrödinger's equation] from? It's not possible to derive it from anything you know. It came out of the mind of Schrödinger."**
>
> Richard Feynman